

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1998-06-16

1 April 1998 regarding the responsibility of parents for their children's behav-
2 ior, and we have been asked to convey the following.

while some opportunities for service in the Administrative order are

3 clearly reserved for those who are over twenty-one years of age, at age fifteen
4 the individual has the privilege of affirming, in his own name, his faith in
5 bahá'u'lláh. The importance of attaining spiritual maturity at the age of
6 fifteen is that it marks that point in life at which the believer takes into his own hands
the responsibility for his spiritual destiny.^{272.7e}

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274 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

275 60The following extract from a Tablet of 'Abdu'l-b ahá links the attainment

of maturity with the deepening of one's understanding and comprehen-

276 sion of the realities of life, and the enhancement of one's very capacity for

277 understanding:

know thou that before maturity man liveth from day to day and

comprehendeth only such matters as are superficial and outwardly

obvious. however, when he cometh of age he understandeth the reali-

278 ties of things and the inner truths. indeed, in his comprehension, his

279 feelings, his deductions and his discoveries, every day of his life after

maturity is equal to a year before it.²⁷³⁻¹

280 while parents may grieve at some of the choices their children make, at the

281 age of maturity a son or daughter is then essentially responsible for the deci-sions he
or she takes and becomes answerable to god accordingly. parents

282 should continue in every way possible to help, encourage, and guide their

283 children, but they should recognize clearly the basic change in account-
284 ability that has occurred.

Department of the secretariat

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Appointment of Continental Counselors

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]